

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 30

Group 30 Vocabulary

1. Aberrant

Meaning: Different from what is normal or expected; abnormal.

Tip to remember: Aberrant sounds like “abnormal error.” If something is aberrant, it is an abnormal deviation.

Sentence: The scientist repeated the experiment because the result seemed aberrant.

2. Abide

Meaning: To accept, tolerate, or follow; to remain.

Tip to remember: Think of “abide by rules.” If you abide by something, you follow it.

Sentence: All students must abide by the examination rules.

3. Bravado

Meaning: A false show of courage or confidence.

Tip to remember: Bravado sounds like brave, but it is often fake bravery shown to impress others.

Sentence: His bravado disappeared when the real challenge began.

4. Callow

Meaning: Young, inexperienced, and immature.

Tip to remember: Think of a young bird that has not grown feathers yet. It is callow and inexperienced.

Sentence: The callow intern made many mistakes during his first week.

5. Capitulate

Meaning: To surrender or give in after resistance.

Tip to remember: Think of a captain finally lowering the flag and surrendering. That is capitulating.

Sentence: After hours of negotiation, the company finally capitulated to the workers' demands.

6. Cogitate

Meaning: To think deeply or carefully.

Tip to remember: Cogitate sounds like cognition, which relates to thinking.

Sentence: He sat quietly to cogitate on his future plans.

7. **Deportment**
Meaning: A person's behavior, posture, or manner of conduct.
Tip to remember: Think of how you carry yourself in public. That is deportment.
Sentence: Her calm deportment impressed the interview panel.
8. **Extemporize**
Meaning: To speak, perform, or do something without preparation.
Tip to remember: Think of giving a speech on the spot without notes. That is extemporizing.
Sentence: When the slides failed, she had to extemporize her presentation.
9. **Factious**
Meaning: Causing division or conflict within a group.
Tip to remember: Factious sounds like faction. A factious person creates factions or divisions.
Sentence: The factious debate split the committee into two groups.
10. **Fallow**
Meaning: Unused or inactive, especially land left unplanted.
Tip to remember: Think of farmland resting for a season. That land is fallow.
Sentence: His creative mind had been fallow for months before he began writing again.
11. **Feint**
Meaning: A deceptive movement intended to distract or mislead.
Tip to remember: Feint sounds like faint, but in fighting it means a fake move.
Sentence: The boxer used a feint to confuse his opponent.
12. **Flagrant**
Meaning: Clearly offensive, shocking, or obviously wrong.
Tip to remember: Think of a mistake so obvious it waves like a flag. That is flagrant.
Sentence: The company committed a flagrant violation of safety rules.
13. **Gratuitous**
Meaning: Unnecessary or uncalled for; given freely.
Tip to remember: GRE meaning is often "unnecessary." Think of extra violence in a movie that adds nothing. That is gratuitous.
Sentence: The essay contained gratuitous details that weakened the argument.
14. **Grovel**
Meaning: To behave with excessive humility or submission.
Tip to remember: Think of someone crawling on the ground to please a powerful person. That is groveling.
Sentence: He refused to grovel before the corrupt official.
15. **Indecorous**
Meaning: Improper, rude, or lacking good manners.

Tip to remember: Decorous means proper and polite. Indecorous means not proper.
Sentence: His indecorous behavior shocked everyone at the formal dinner.

16. **Intrigue**

Meaning: To interest or fascinate; also, a secret plot.

Tip to remember: GRE trick: intrigue can mean fascination or secret plotting.

Sentence: The mysterious research problem intrigued the young engineer.

17. **Nominal**

Meaning: Existing in name only; very small.

Tip to remember: Nominal comes from name. Something nominal may have the name but not the real power.

Sentence: He was the nominal head of the organization, but others made the decisions.

18. **Obdurate**

Meaning: Stubborn and refusing to change one's opinion.

Tip to remember: Obdurate sounds like "durable." An obdurate person has a durable, unchanging mind.

Sentence: The obdurate leader refused to accept any compromise.

19. **Obstreperous**

Meaning: Noisy, unruly, and difficult to control.

Tip to remember: Think of a noisy classroom that refuses to stay quiet. That class is obstreperous.

Sentence: The obstreperous crowd disrupted the meeting.

20. **Odious**

Meaning: Extremely unpleasant, hateful, or disgusting.

Tip to remember: Odious sounds like odor. A bad odor is unpleasant; odious behavior is morally unpleasant.

Sentence: The dictator's odious actions were condemned worldwide.

21. **Plucky**

Meaning: Brave, spirited, and determined.

Tip to remember: Think of someone with the courage to "pluck up" strength in danger.

Sentence: The plucky student continued trying despite repeated failures.

22. **Precocious**

Meaning: Showing advanced ability at an unusually young age.

Tip to remember: Think of a child solving adult-level math problems. That child is precocious.

Sentence: The precocious child learned programming at the age of eight.

23. **Remuneration**

Meaning: Payment or compensation for work.

Tip to remember: Remuneration sounds like money. It means the money you receive

for service.

Sentence: The internship offered valuable experience but little remuneration.

24. **Slovenly**

Meaning: Messy, careless, or untidy in appearance or work.

Tip to remember: Think of someone submitting a dirty, disorganized assignment. That work is slovenly.

Sentence: The professor rejected the slovenly report.

25. **Soliloquy**

Meaning: A speech in which a person speaks their thoughts aloud, often alone.

Tip to remember: “Solo” means alone, and “loquy” relates to speaking. Soliloquy means speaking alone.

Sentence: Hamlet’s famous soliloquy reveals his inner conflict.

26. **Spurn**

Meaning: To reject with contempt.

Tip to remember: Spurn sounds like “push and turn away.” It means rejecting harshly.

Sentence: She spurned the dishonest offer.

27. **Stolid**

Meaning: Calm, unemotional, and not easily excited.

Tip to remember: Stolid sounds like solid. A stolid person is solid and unmoved emotionally.

Sentence: He remained stolid even during the emergency.

28. **Temerity**

Meaning: Reckless boldness or foolish courage.

Tip to remember: Think of someone having the nerve to insult a strict teacher. That reckless boldness is temerity.

Sentence: He had the temerity to question the judge rudely.

29. **Tenuous**

Meaning: Weak, thin, or not strongly supported.

Tip to remember: Tenuous sounds like thin. A tenuous argument is thin and weak.

Sentence: The link between the two events was tenuous.

30. **Verve**

Meaning: Energy, enthusiasm, and lively spirit.

Tip to remember: Verve sounds like vibrant. A person with verve is full of life.

Sentence: She delivered the presentation with confidence and verve.